Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Problem Statement:

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

User Story:

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

Project Objective:

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

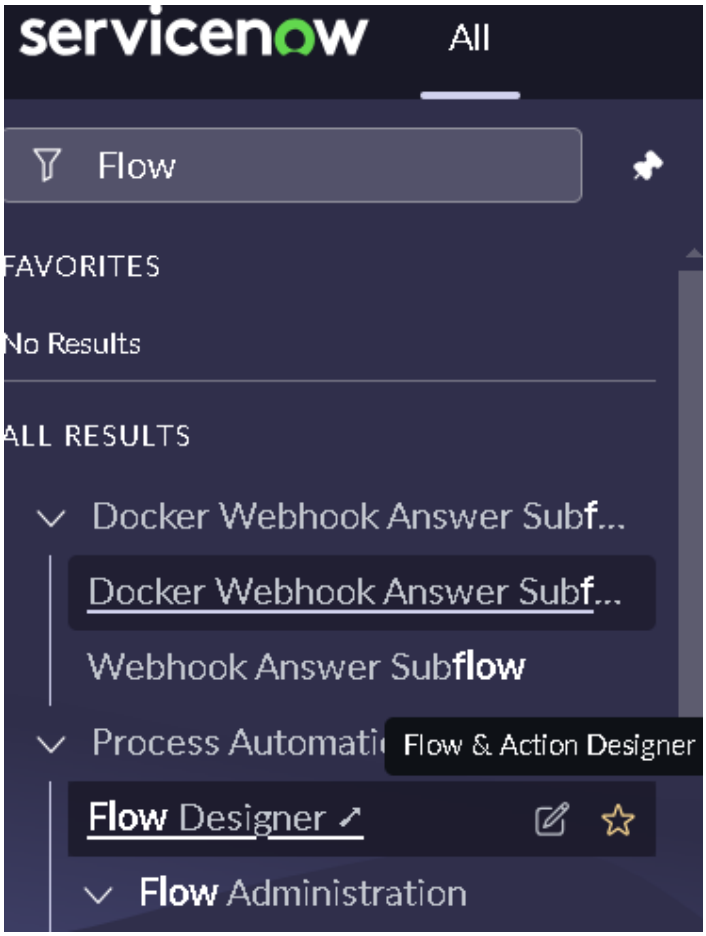
1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

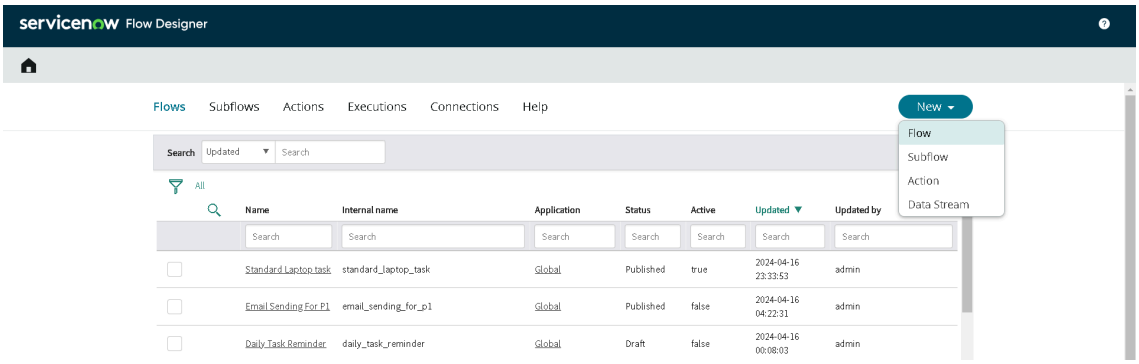
TASK INITIATION

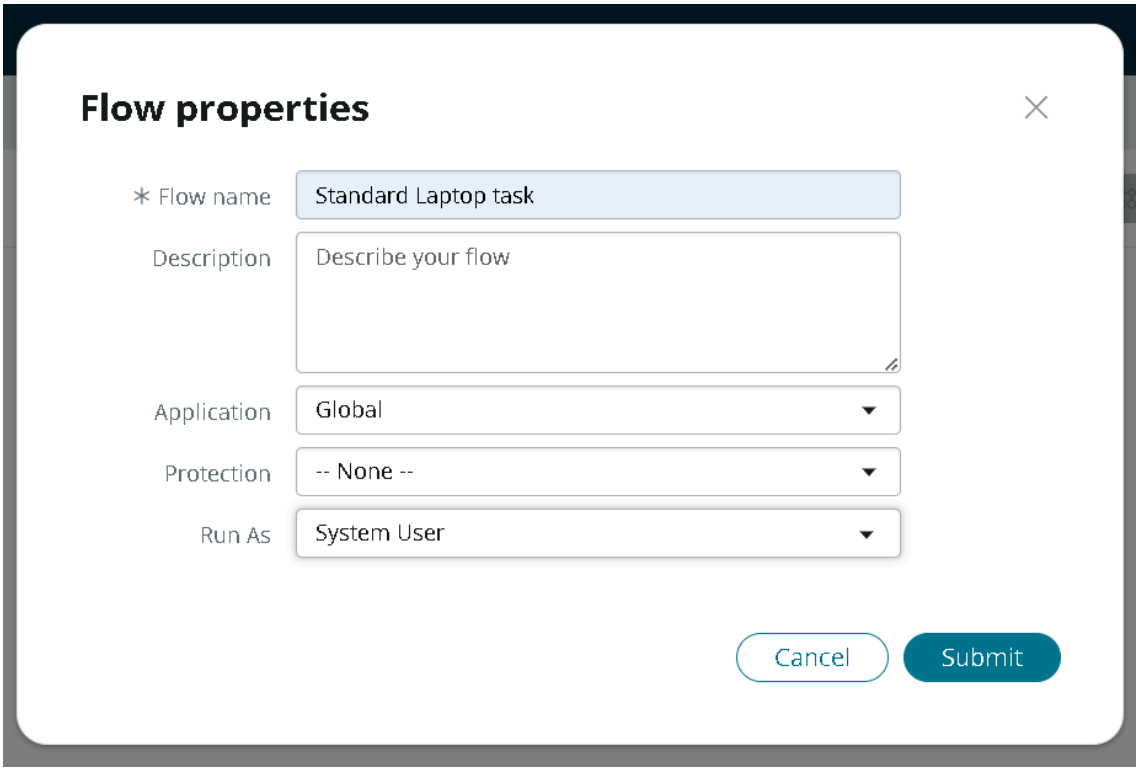
Milestone 1 : Flow

Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

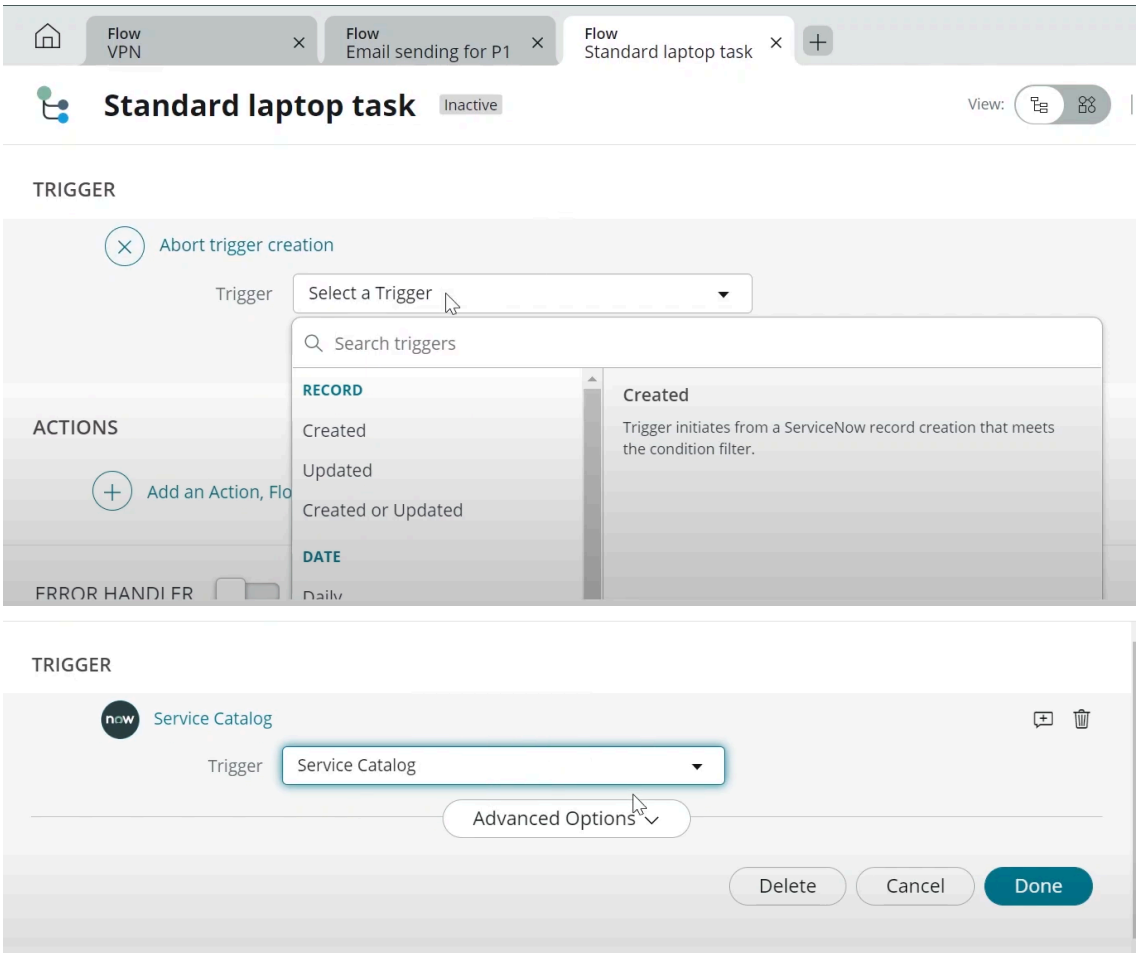
1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as " Standard laptop task".
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as " System user " from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.



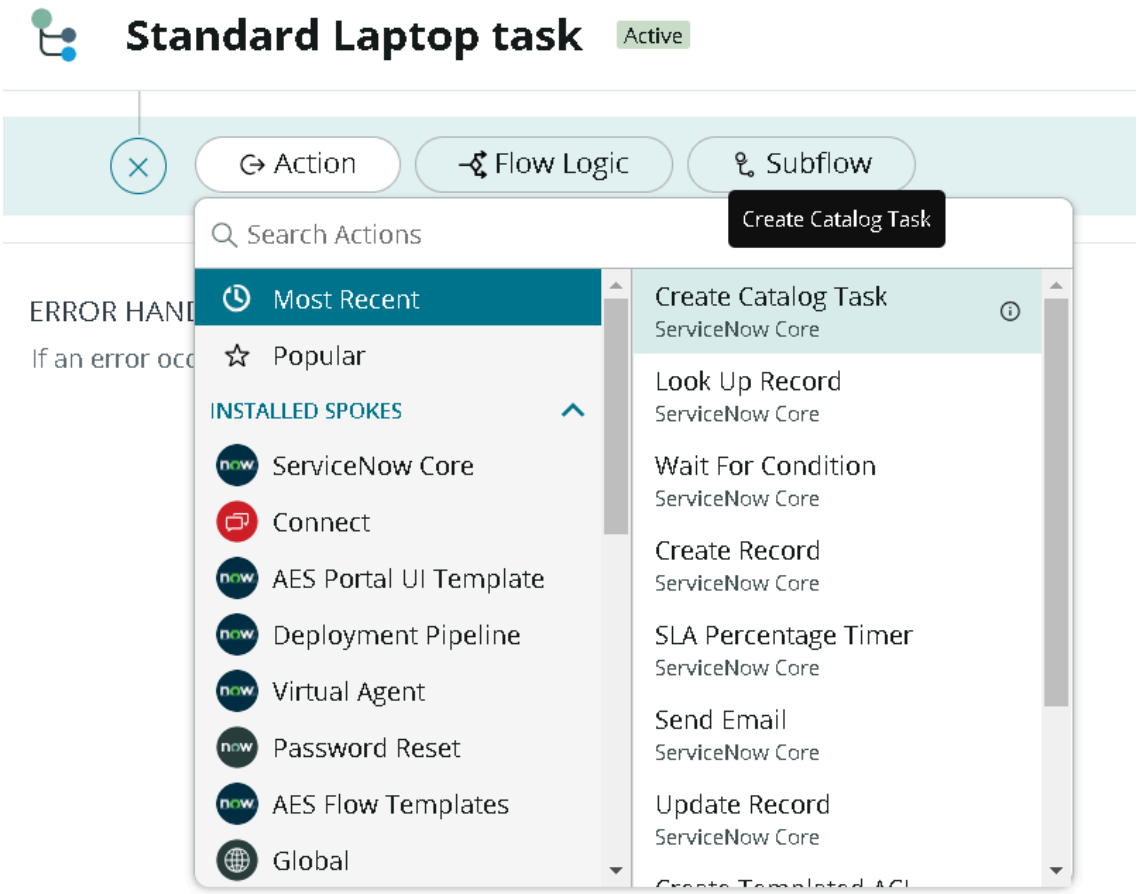


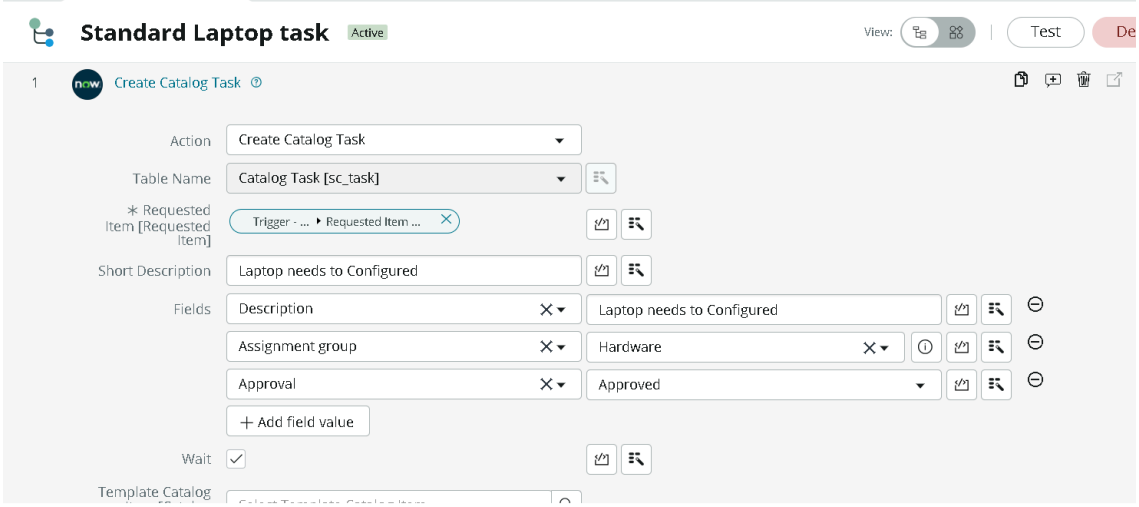


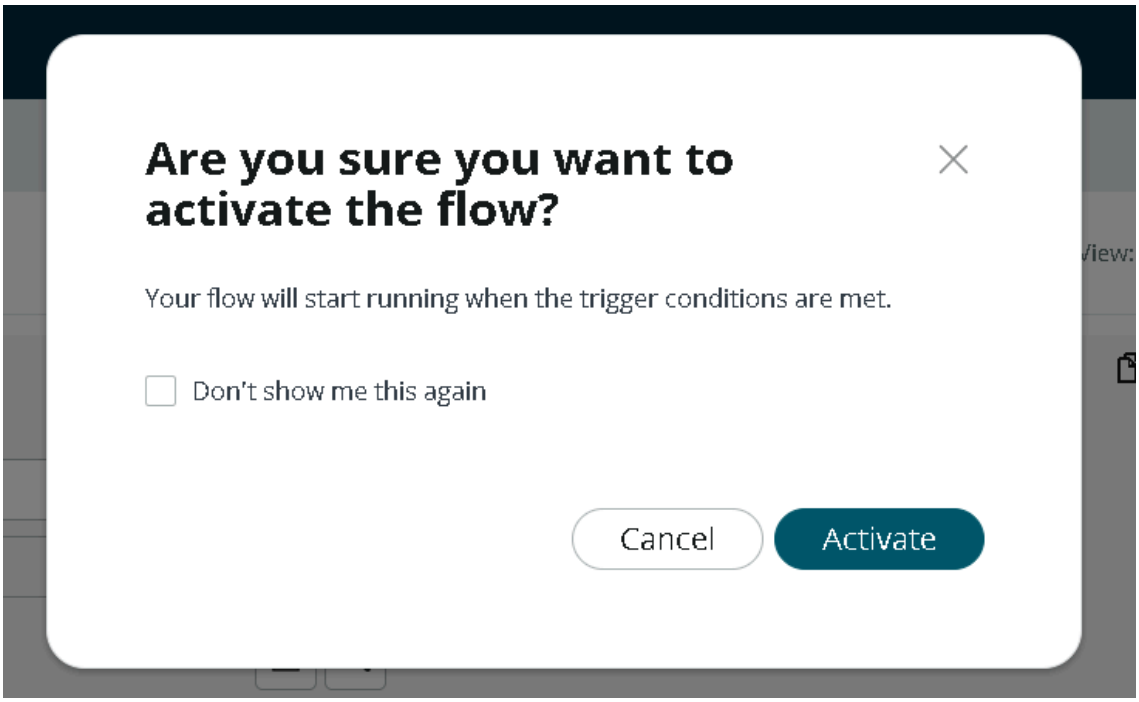
9. Click on Add a trigger
10. Select the trigger in that Search for “ Service Catalog ” and select that.
11. After that click on Done.



12. Now under Actions.
13. Click on Add an action.
14. Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
15. Mention these in that action
16. Action as Create Catalog Task
17. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
18. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
19. Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
20. Click on add field value
21. Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
22. Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
23. Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
24. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
25. Click on save the Flow.
26. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.


Standard Laptop task
Active
Action
Flow Logic
Subflow
Create Catalog Task
Search Actions
ERROR HAND
If an error occ
Most Recent
Popular
INSTALLED SPOKES
ServiceNow Core
Connect
AES Portal UI Template
Deployment Pipeline
Virtual Agent
Password Reset
AES Flow Templates
Global
Create Catalog Task
ServiceNow Core
Look Up Record
ServiceNow Core
Wait For Condition
ServiceNow Core
Create Record
ServiceNow Core
SLA Percentage Timer
ServiceNow Core
Send Email
ServiceNow Core
Update Record
ServiceNow Core

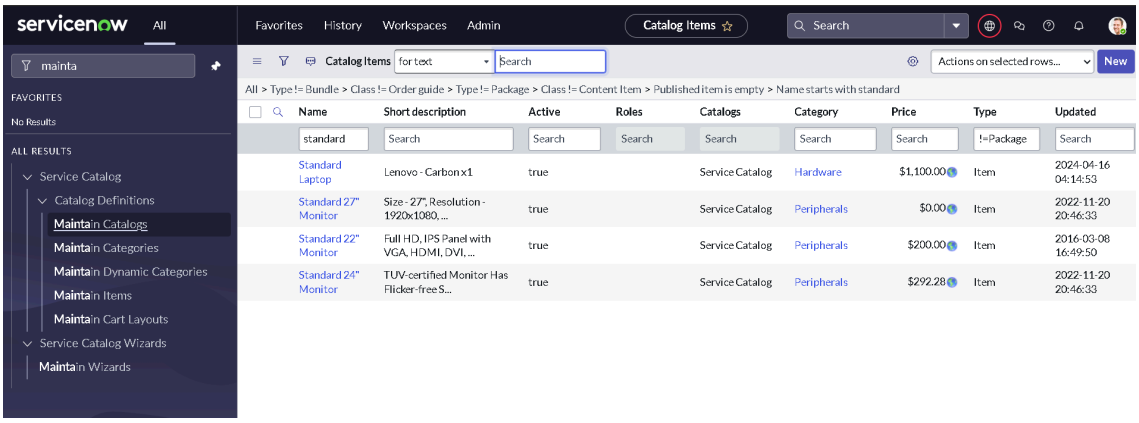

Standard Laptop task
Active
View:
Test
1
Create Catalog Task
Action
Create Catalog Task
Table Name
Catalog Task [sc_task]
* Requested Item [Requested Item]
Trigger - ... ▸ Requested Item ...
Short Description
Laptop needs to Configured
Fields
Description
Laptop needs to Configured
Assignment group
Hardware
Approval
Approved
+ Add field value
Wait
Template Catalog

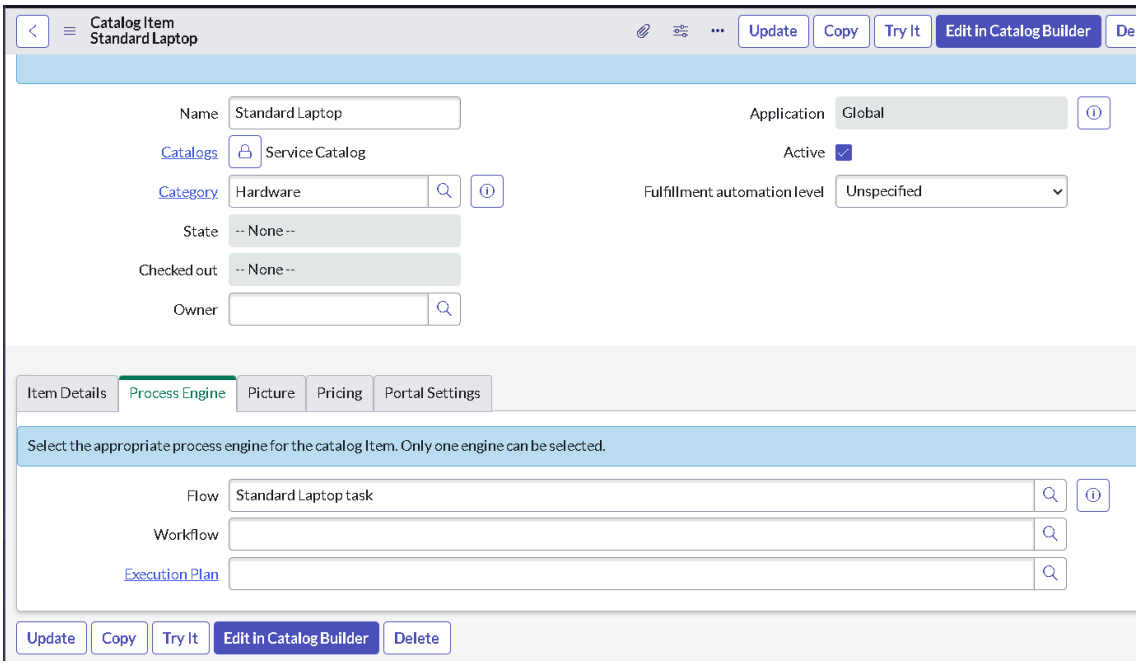


Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name " Standard Laptop Task".
8. Click on the menu to save the record.

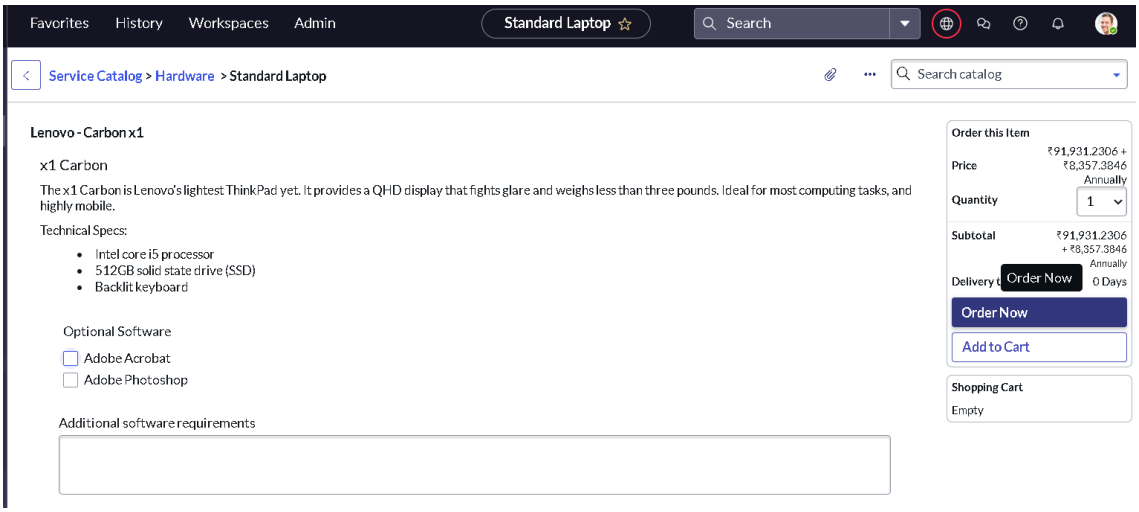




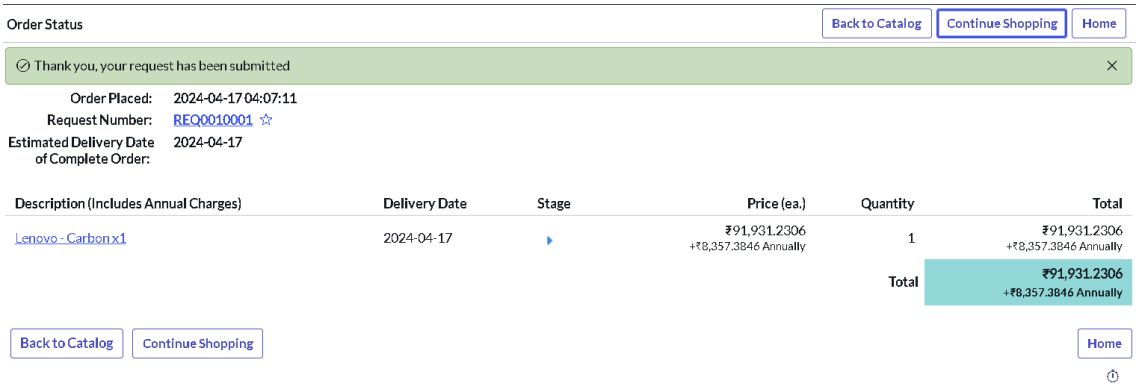
Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

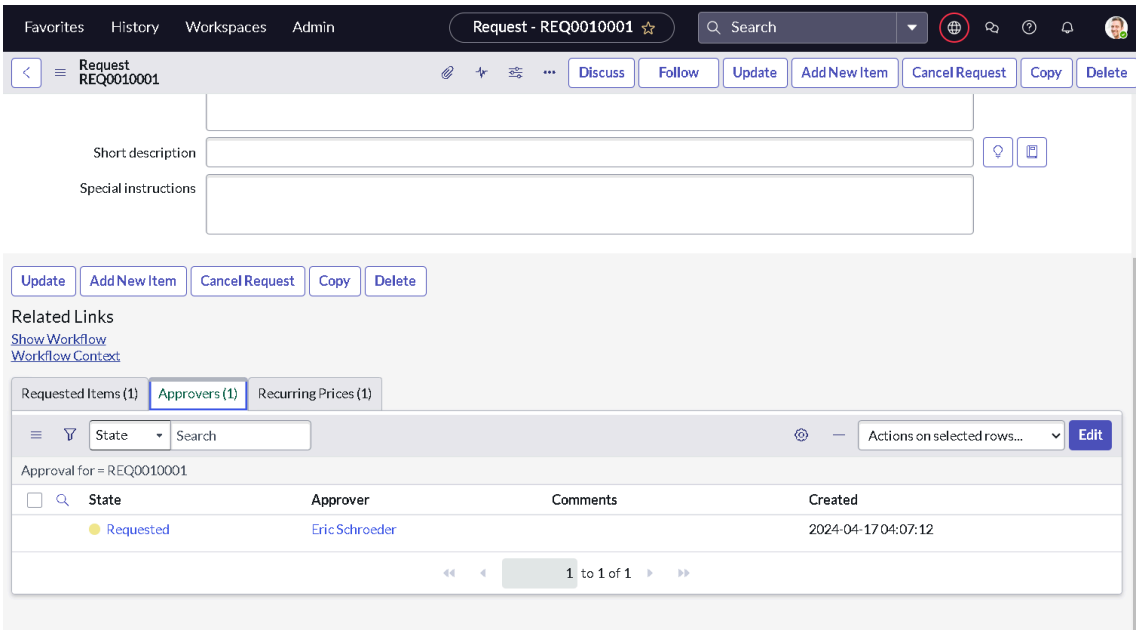
1. Click on All >> Search for " Service Catalog ".
2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
3. Scroll a bit to find the " Standard Laptop " click on that.
4. After that click on " Order Now " to place the request.



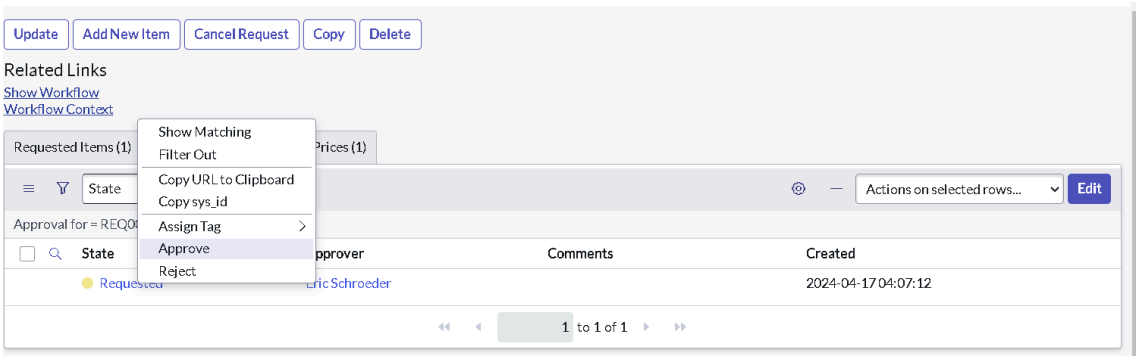
5. Now we will see the Order status
6. In that click on the Request Number



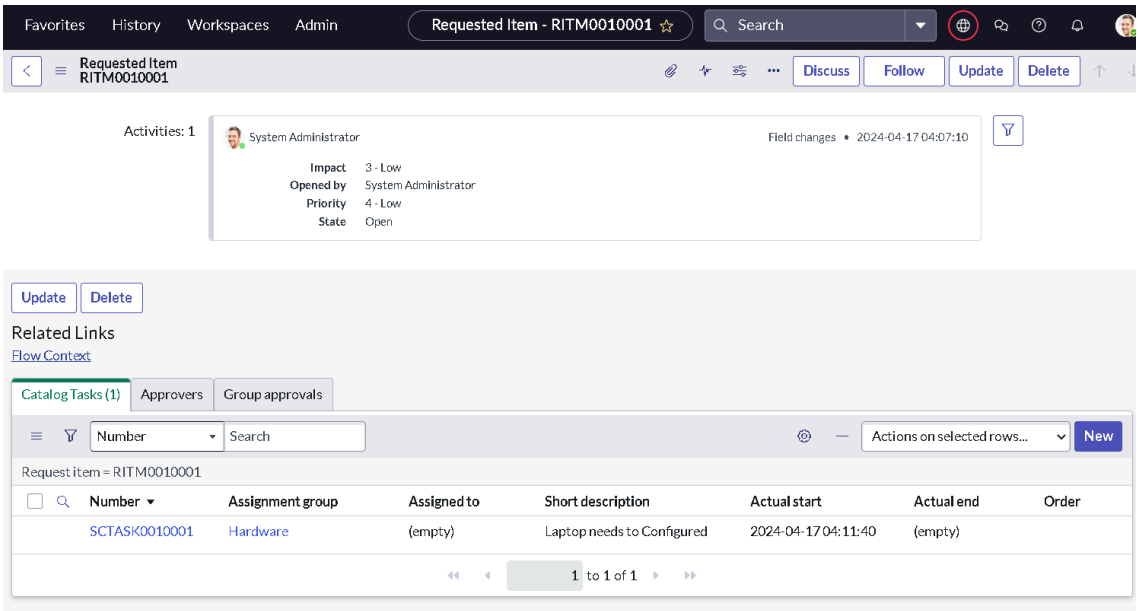
7. It will open the Requested number record.
8. Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.



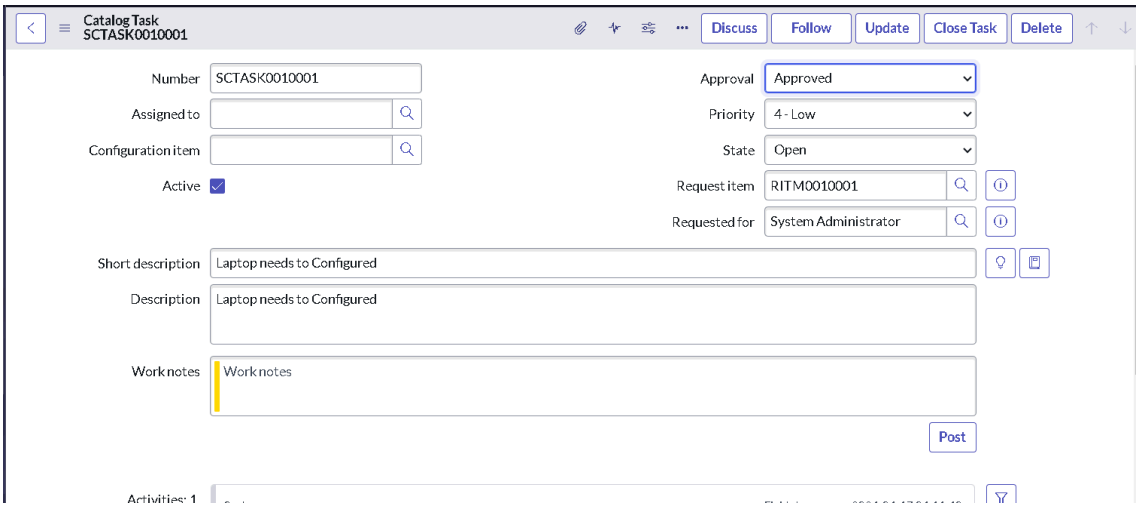
9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.



10. Then click on the Requested item Section
11. Open that Requested Item record



12. Scroll down to the “ Catalog tasks ” Section
13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.



Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.